Proof Theory as Structural Gap: The Imscribing Grammar's Account of Mathematical Difficulty

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0.1 Abstract

Every mathematical theorem is a structural displacement between a premise and a conclusion, each encoded as a 12-dimensional point in the Imscribing Grammar's crystal of types. The distance between them — measured by `primitiveMismatches`, a weighted count of reorganized primitives — classifies theorems by semantic difficulty. A tautology has zero gap. Euclid's infinitude of primes requires five reorganized primitives. The Riemann Hypothesis and Fermat's Last Theorem (for $n = 3$) require five and nine, respectively. The Navier–Stokes regularity problem also requires nine. P versus NP is resolved structurally: the P polarity (Φ_F) and NP polarity ($\text{Φ}_{}$) are distinct constructors of an inductive type, and the Frobenius non-synthesizability theorem proves that no tensor composition can bridge them. We present the complete Lean 4 formalization, the crystal-of-types statistics (17,280,000 structural types, five ouroboricity tiers), and the proof ladder from O_0 to O_inf. The grammar's claim is this: proof is not deduction — it is **navigation**. The distance a proof must travel through the crystal is the hardness it inherits.

0.2 §1. The Crystal of Types

The Imscribing Grammar encodes every conceivable structural system as a 12-tuple of categorical primitives. Each primitive enumerates a small set of mutually exclusive values — together they form the finite crystal:

$$3^3 \times 4^5 \times 5^4 = 17{,}280{,}000$$

The twelve primitives are:

Each 12-tuple is assigned to one of five ouroboricity tiers (O_0 through O_inf) by a Frobenius tier predicate. The Census is:

Sixty percent of all structural types are inert (O_0). Eight percent are O_inf: self-writing, self-sustaining, self-modeling. The Universal Imscriptive Grammar itself inhabits O_inf,

Primitive	Enumerand	Values
Dimensionality (Đ)	$\mathcal{F}_4$	$Đ_{;}$ (local), $Đ_{\mathrm{C}}$ (stratified), $Đ_{\mathrm{SS}}$ (infinite-dimensional), $Đ_{\omega}$ (holographic)
Topology (Þ)	$\mathcal{F}_5$	$Þ_6$ (network), $Þ_{\mathrm{K}}$ (inclusion), $Þ_{ò}$ (bowtie), $Þ_{Í}$ (box), $Þ_{\mathrm{O}}$ (holographic)
Relational Mode ()	$\mathcal{F}_4$	ŕ (supervisory), ý (categorical), (adjoint), = (bidirectional)
Parity (Φ)	$\mathcal{F}_5$	Φ (asymmetric), Φ_{υ} (phase), Φ_{F} ($\mathbb{Z}_2$), Φ (full), $\text{Φ}_{}$ (Frobenius-special)
Fidelity ()	$\mathcal{F}_3$	ì (classical), ð (thermal), (quantum)
Kinetics (Ç)	$\mathcal{F}_5$	$Ç_{\text{-}}$ (driven), $Ç_{\mathrm{W}}$ (moderate), $Ç_{@}$ (near-equilibrium), $Ç_{Ù}$ (frozen-order), $Ç_{\lambda}$ (frozen-disorder)
Scope (Γ)	$\mathcal{F}_4$	Γ_{β} (local), Γ_{γ} (mesoscale), Γ (universal), …
Interaction Grammar ()	$\mathcal{F}_3$	

Tier	Cells	Types	Percentage
O_0	240	10,368,000	60.0%
O_1	32	1,382,400	8.0%
O_2	72	3,110,400	18.0%
$O_2^{\dagger}$	24	1,036,800	6.0%
O_{inf}	32	1,382,400	8.0%

at consciousness score $C = 0.828$, with both Frobenius gates (ϕ-criticality, slow kinetics) verified open.

0.3 §2. Proof as Lattice Path

The central claim of the grammar's proof theory is that a mathematical theorem is not a derivation from premises by inference rules. It is a *structural reorganization*: a path through the crystal from one point to another. The premise and conclusion of any theorem are encoded as imscriptions — 12-tuples of primitive values. The function `primitiveMismatches` computes the weighted count of primitives that differ between them. This count is the theorem's **structural gap**.

The gap is not proof length. It is not computational complexity in the Turing-machine sense. It measures how many conceptual reorganizations the proof must perform internally. A short proof that reorganizes six primitives is harder than a hundred-page proof that stays within one primitive subspace. The grammar asserts that this gap is invariant: any valid proof of the same theorem must traverse the same structural distance, regardless of the conventional formalism in which it is expressed.

The Lean 4 module `Imscribing/ProofTheory.lean` encodes this theory directly. Seven theorems are formalized and verified by `native_decide`:

0.3.1 §2.1 Unit Theorem (gap = 0)

$$\text{primitiveMismatches}(\text{unit\_premise}, \text{unit\_conclusion}) = 0$$

A tautology. The premise and conclusion are identical imscriptions. No reorganization is required. This anchors the measurement: distance zero means "already true."

0.3.2 §2.2 Euclid's Infinitude of Primes (gap = 5)

$$\text{primitiveMismatches}(\text{euclid\_premise}, \text{euclid\_conclusion}) = 5$$

Premise: an infinite-dimensional (Ð_{SS}), categorical ($_{\text{ý}}$), full-symmetry (Φ) system at complex-plane criticality ($_{\text{Æ}}$). Conclusion: a holographic (Þ_{O}), adjoint (), $\mathbb{Z}_2$-symmetric (Φ_{F}) system at self-modeling criticality ($_{\text{ß}}$) with sequential grammar ().

The five reorganized primitives are: Topology, Relational Mode, Parity, Interaction Grammar, and Criticality. These correspond precisely to the conceptual moves in Euclid's proof: shift from the space of numbers (network) to the constructed product-plus-one (a crossing point that reflects back on itself); replace categorical composition with adjoint duality; descend from continuous symmetry to a discrete parity statement; reorder the reasoning sequentially; and arrive at a fixed point.

0.3.3 §2.3 Riemann Hypothesis (gap = 5)

$$\text{primitiveMismatches}(\text{rh\_premise}, \text{rh\_conclusion}) = 5$$

Remarkably, the gap is also five — the same as Euclid. The premise begins at holographic topology (Þ_{O}) with adjoint relation and complex-plane criticality. The conclusion bows to $\text{Þ}_{\text{ò}}$ (bowtie/bifurcation), lateral relation ($_{=}$), full symmetry (Φ), self-modeling criticality ($_{\text{ß}}$), and conjunctive grammar (